

APPLICATION FORM FOR JAPAN'S TECHNICAL COOPERATION

1. **Date of Entry:** Day 11 Month May Year 2026
2. **Applicant:** The Office of the Council of Ministers (OCM), Royal Government of Cambodia
3. **Technical Cooperation (T/C) Title:** The Project for Modernization of Digital Core Infrastructure and Data Center Resilience for the Office of the Council of Ministers
4. **Type of the T/C** ※Select **ONLY ONE** scheme.
☒ Technical Cooperation Project
☐ Technical Cooperation for Development Planning
☐ Science and Technology Research Partnership for Sustainable Development (SATREPS)
☐ Individual Expert (☐ New / ☐ Extension)
☐ Individual Training
5. **Contact Point (Implementing Agency):** General Department of Digital Transformation, OCM
Address: Friendship Building, 41 Russian Federation Blvd (110), Phnom Penh, Cambodia
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6. Background of the T/C

The Office of the Council of Ministers (OCM) serves as the central administrative hub of the Royal Government of Cambodia. As the government transitions toward a digital society, the OCM is prioritizing a comprehensive digital transformation to modernize internal operations. However, the foundational digital infrastructure at the Friendship and Brotherhood Buildings has become a critical bottleneck. Legacy hardware and network systems have reached the end of their service life, leading to frequent performance degradation and increasing the risk of failure for mission-critical systems.

To overcome these limitations, the OCM seeks to establish a digital environment that aligns with the advanced standards seen in leading regional peers such as Japan, Singapore, and South Korea. Currently, the OCM manages aging data centers where hardware lacks the high availability and modern security features required for a "Smart Government" framework. This project is a strategic response to this gap, aiming to transition the OCM from outdated systems to a high-performance digital ecosystem that reflects global best practices.

The proposed Technical Cooperation (T/C) is designed to build a modern, resilient digital backbone by upgrading the OCM Data Center to a Tier II classification. This includes the installation of high-performance servers, professional rack systems, and robust N+1 redundant power supply to ensure 99.741% availability. This data center will serve as the sovereign "digital brain" of the OCM, providing the necessary infrastructure to host specialized software and document management platforms with 24/7 reliability.

Parallel to the data center upgrade, the project will implement a comprehensive Network Connectivity architecture. This involves the deployment of a 24-core fiber optic backbone between primary buildings and the modernization of internal network paths to support 10Gbps speeds. The scope further includes enterprise-grade managed Wi-Fi systems and unified network management protocols. These enhancements ensure that government officials have high-speed, secure access to digital platforms on par with international standards.

Ultimately, this project is a strategic priority to ensure data sovereignty and national security. By modernizing these core components, the OCM will achieve a "Mission-Critical" environment where essential government software can operate without interruption. This infrastructure is designed with a "Scalable and Modular" approach, allowing for future expansion to Tier III standards, ensuring Cambodia's administrative core remains technologically robust for the future.

7. Outline of the T/C

(1) Overall Goal

The effectiveness of the OCM's digital governance is modernized to meet international standards. The project establishes a high-availability, secure

digital core that ensures administrative continuity and data sovereignty in support of the Pentagonal Strategy.

(2) T/C Purpose

The capacity of the OCM's digital infrastructure and technical personnel is enhanced to support mission-critical administrative systems.

Indicator 1: Upgrade the OCM Data Center to a Tier II classification with 99.741% availability.

Indicator 2: Establish a 10Gbps fiber optic backbone between the Friendship and Brotherhood buildings.

(3) Outputs

Output 1: Establish a resilient, Tier-standard Data Center environment.

Output 2: Modernize campus-wide network connectivity with high-speed fiber and managed Wi-Fi.

Output 3: Strengthen the technical expertise of OCM engineers in managing modern virtualization and core infrastructure.

(4) T/C Site

The Office of the Council of Ministers (OCM) Campus, No. 41, Russian Federation Blvd (110), Phnom Penh, Cambodia.

(5) T/C Activities

Output 1: Establish a resilient, Tier-standard Data Center environment

Activity 1-1: Conduct a comprehensive technical assessment of current power, cooling, and space availability at the Friendship and Brotherhood buildings.

Activity 1-2: Finalize the architectural design for Tier II standards, focusing on N+1 redundancy for power and cooling infrastructure.

Activity 1-3: Procure, install, and configure high-performance enterprise server clusters and 42U rack systems.

Activity 1-4: Implement automated backup and disaster recovery protocols using professional virtualization layers.

Output 2: Modernize campus-wide network connectivity and technical expertise

Activity 2-1: Deploy a 24-core fiber optic backbone to provide 10Gbps throughput between administrative buildings.

Activity 2-2: Install and optimize campus-wide managed Wi-Fi 6 Access Points and core switching hardware.

Activity 2-3: Configure real-time network health monitoring (PRTG) and advanced firewall security (pfSense).

Activity 2-4: Execute a structured technical training program for OCM engineers on maintaining high-availability infrastructure.

(6) Input from the Recipient Government

The Office of the Council of Ministers (OCM) will provide a high-level management structure and the necessary infrastructure to ensure the project's sustainability.

- **Project Director**

A senior official at the Excellency level will be designated to provide strategic direction, ensure policy alignment with the Pentagonal Strategy, and oversee inter-ministerial coordination.

- **Project Manager**

The Deputy Director General of the General Department of Digital Transformation will serve as the primary focal point, managing daily operations and technical coordination with the Japanese mission.

- **Technical Working Group**

A team of 5 to 7 Senior IT Engineers from the General Department of Digital Transformation will be assigned to work alongside Japanese experts to facilitate a full transfer of technical knowledge.

- **Institutional Support**

The OCM will provide furnished office space for the expert team, full access to server room facilities, and all required utilities (electricity and cooling) for the project duration.

(7) Input from the Japanese Government

To achieve the modernization of the OCM's Digital Core Infrastructure and Data Center, the following specialized expertise and technical resources are requested from Japan:

- **Japanese Experts:**

- o **Lead Infrastructure Architect**

This expert will provide high-level strategic guidance and technical

oversight to ensure the transition of the OCM server environment meets international Tier II standards.

- **Senior Network Infrastructure Engineer**

This specialist will lead the technical deployment of the high-speed 24-core fiber optic backbone and the implementation of campus-wide secure wireless systems.

- **Systems Security and Virtualization Specialist**

This expert will supervise the critical implementation of server virtualization layers, hardware hardening, and the establishment of robust disaster recovery protocols.

- **Equipment and Technical Supply:**

The project requires the provision of enterprise-grade hardware, including high-performance server clusters, 42U rack systems, and N+1 redundant UPS units. Additionally, 24-core fiber optic cabling, core switching hardware, and Wi-Fi 6 access points are requested to establish the physical backbone.

- **Training and Capacity Building:**

A comprehensive program including technical workshops in Cambodia and a specialized study tour in Japan is requested. This will allow OCM technical leadership to observe "Smart Government" infrastructure and modern data center operations firsthand.

8. Implementation Schedule

Month January Year 2027 ~ Month January Year 2029

9. Description of an Implementing Agency

The General Department of Digital Transformation of the Office of the Council of Ministers (OCM) is mandated to lead the digital modernization of the government's administrative core in alignment with the Pentagonal Strategy Phase I. The department's primary responsibility is to formulate and implement digital policies, manage high-availability server infrastructure, and ensure the cybersecurity and resilience of mission-critical systems such as the national meeting and email platforms. It serves as the technical backbone of the OCM, tasked with integrating emerging technologies into daily government operations while maintaining data sovereignty and

administrative continuity. In this sense, the General Department operates as the centralized technical hub for all digital transformation initiatives within the Office of the Council of Ministers.

The organizational structure of the General Department of Digital Transformation comprises a Director General, several Deputy Director Generals with specialized technical oversight, and four primary technical departments including the Software Development Department, the Cybersecurity and Network Infrastructure Department, the System Administration and Data Center Management Department, and the Administrative and Policy Coordination Department. Each department is overseen by one director and supported by deputy directors who manage the specific technical workflows and engineering teams. This hierarchy ensures a streamlined approach to both software application development and the physical management of data center assets. The total staff of the General Department of Digital Transformation consists of 17 personnel in total, including civil servants and technical specialists who collaborate to maintain the OCM's digital ecosystem.

10. Activities in the same sector of other donor agencies, the recipient government, and other actors (private companies, financial institutions, NGO/NPOs, Japanese municipalities, Universities, and research institutions, etc.):

The Office of the Council of Ministers (OCM) has not requested the same project for Digital Core Infrastructure and Data Center Resilience from any other donor agencies or international partners. While the OCM is currently engaged in internal software modernization and digital governance initiatives—such as the specialized meeting and email tracking system—these efforts are primarily focused on the application layer and internal process automation. There is currently no other donor-funded project in the target area providing the specific hardware redundancy, Tier II data center modernization, or fiber optic backbone upgrades required for this project. Previous efforts in the sector have been limited to departmental software deployments, and this request is based on the critical need to provide a resilient physical foundation for those systems.

The proposed project is designed to be highly complementary to the existing efforts of the General Department of Digital Transformation. By establishing a stable and high-performance infrastructure, this technical cooperation will provide the necessary environment for the software systems currently being developed by the OCM technical team. To date, no co-creation discussions for potential collaboration with other actors have been held regarding this specific infrastructure upgrade, ensuring that JICA's involvement will serve as the primary and unique contribution to the OCM's physical digital core. The project will bridge the current gap between the advanced application-layer requirements and the legacy hardware environment, ensuring a complete and modern digital ecosystem within the OCM.

11. Global Issues

- (1) Gender: The project is committed to the principle of equal opportunity and institutional inclusivity. It ensures that all personnel have equitable access to specialized technical training and capacity-building programs, promoting a professional environment where technical advancement is based strictly on merit and competence.
- (2) Poverty: The project scope is strictly limited to the modernization of internal digital infrastructure and administrative systems within the Office of the Council of Ministers. As such, there is no direct poverty reduction component associated with this technical cooperation.
- (3) Climate change (☒ alignment with national climate policy such as Nationally Determined Contribution) : The project prioritizes the implementation of "Green IT" by selecting high-efficiency server clusters and modern cooling systems. This approach reduces the OCM's total energy consumption and carbon footprint, directly supporting Cambodia's national commitment to environmental sustainability.
- (4) Others: By establishing a resilient digital core, the project facilitates the transition toward a paperless administrative environment, further contributing to national environmental conservation and reducing physical resource waste.

12. Environmental and Social Considerations

The proposed project consists of installing IT hardware and digital infrastructure within the existing facilities of the Office of the Council of

Ministers. As the project does not involve construction, land acquisition, or involuntary resettlement, it is expected to have no adverse environmental or social impacts. Please refer to the attached Screening Format for the complete assessment.

(Note) If JICA considers that the environmental and social considerations are required to the T/C, the applicants agree on JICA's information disclosure of the T/C for public hearing in accordance with JICA guidelines for environmental and social considerations as stated in Question 11 of the attached Screening Format.

Others (if any)

Signed: _____

Title: _____

On behalf of the Government of _____

Date: _____

Additional Form for Expert

※If the applicants select the Individual Expert in 4., this form needs to be filled out.

1. Type of Assignment

☐ New ☐ Extension

If this type is "Extension", please show whose extension it is.

2. Qualifications and Experience required

(1) Age Limit

(2) Educational Background (Doctor / Master / Bachelor)

(3) Practical Experience on Related Field

(4) Language (Name / Level)

(5) Other Qualification and Experience

Additional Form for SATREPS

1. Japanese Partner of SATREPS

☐ Coordination for joint research has been completed with Japanese research institutions.

(1)Research Institutions :

(2)Principal Investigator of Japanese side :

(3)Other Researchers :

2. Institutional profile

(1)Research Institutions :

(2)Principal Investigator :

(3)Previous international joint research projects related this SATREPS (Give their titles in English) If the projects are supported by other agencies, provide agency names, and years.

(4)Current research projects related this SATREPS (Give their titles in English) If the projects are supported by other agencies, provide agency names, and years)

3. List of available equipment for the proposed research

4. Written agreements for joint research with Japanese research institutions

Screening Format (Environmental and Social Considerations)

Name of Proposed Project: The Project for Modernization of Digital Core Infrastructure and Data Center Resilience for the Office of the Council of Ministers

Project Executing Organization: General Department of Digital Transformation, Office of the Council of Ministers (OCM)

Name, Address, Organization, and Contact Point of a Responsible Officer:

Name: Soth Thy

Address: Friendship Building, 41 Russian Federation Blvd (110), Phnom Penh, Cambodia

Organization: General Department of Digital Transformation, OCM

Tel: (+855) 12 807 393

E-Mail: soth.thy@ocm.gov.kh

Date: May 11, 2026

Signature:

Check Items

Please write "to be advised (TBA)" when the details of a project are yet to be determined.

Question 1: Office of the Council of Ministers (Friendship Building), No. 41 Russian Federation Blvd, Phnom Penh, Cambodia.

Question 2: Scale and contents of the project (approximate area, facilities area, production, electricity generated, etc.)

2-1. Project profile (scale and contents): The project involves the installation of high-availability server clusters, N+1 redundant cooling systems, and fiber optic network infrastructure within existing OCM facilities to ensure government data resilience.

2-2. How was the necessity of the project confirmed?

Is the project consistent with the higher program/policy?

☒ YES: Please describe the higher program/policy.

(Cambodia Pentagonal Strategy Phase I and the National Digital Economy and Society Policy Framework 2021-2035)

☐ NO

2-3. Did the proponent consider alternatives before this request?

☐ YES: Please describe outline of the alternatives

()

☒ NO

2-4. Did the proponent implement meetings with the related stakeholders before this request?

☒ Implemented ☐ Not implemented

If implemented, please mark the following stakeholders.

- ☒ Administrative body
☐ Local residents
☐ NGO
☐ Others

(1) ☐ The local residents above include socially vulnerable individuals/groups

(Please specify: _____)

(2) ☐ The proponent gave appropriate consideration to ensure participation of the socially vulnerable individuals/groups

Question 3:

Is the project a new one or an ongoing one? In the case of an ongoing project, have you received strong complaints or other comments from local residents?

☒ New ☐ Ongoing (with complaints) ☐ Ongoing (without complaints)
☐ Other (_____)

Question 4:

Is an Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA), including an Initial Environmental Examination (IEE) required for the project according to a law or guidelines of a host country? If yes, is an EIA implemented or planned? If necessary, please fill in the reason why an EIA is required.

☐ Necessary (☐ Implemented / ☐ Ongoing/planning)

(Reason why EIA is required: _____)

☒ Not necessary

☐ Other (please explain: _____)

Question 5:

In the case that steps were taken for an EIA, was the EIA approved by the relevant laws of the host country? If yes, please note the date of approval and the competent authority.

☐ Approved without a supplementary condition (Date of approval: _____ Competent authority: _____)

☐ Approved with a supplementary condition (Date of approval: _____ Competent

- ☐ Under appraisal
- ☐ Under implementation
- ☐ Appraisal process not yet started
- ☐ Other ()

If the project requires a certificate regarding the environment and society other than an EIA, please indicate the title of said certificate. Was it approved?

Question 7:

☐ Yes ☒ No

- ☐ National parks, nationally-designated protected areas (coastal areas, wetlands, areas for ethnic minorities or indigenous peoples and cultural heritage, etc. designated by national governments)
- ☐ Primary forests, natural forests in tropical areas
- ☐ Habitats with important ecological value (coral reefs, mangrove wetlands, tidal flats, etc.)
- ☐ Habitats of rare species that require protection under domestic legislation, international treaties, etc.
- ☐ Areas in danger of large-scale salt accumulation or soil erosion
- ☐ Areas with a remarkable tendency of desertification
- ☐ Areas with unique archeological, historical, or cultural values
- ☐ Areas inhabited by ethnic minorities, indigenous peoples, or nomadic peoples with traditional ways of life, and other areas with special social values

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, please mark the appropriate items.

- ☐ Involuntary resettlement (scale: households, persons)
- ☐ Groundwater pumping (scale: m3/year)
- ☐ Land reclamation, land development, and/or land-clearing (scale: hectares)
- ☐ Logging (scale: hectares)

Question 9:

Please mark related environmental and social impacts, and describe their outlines.

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Air pollution | ☐ Involuntary resettlement |
| ☐ Water pollution | ☐ Local economies, such as employment, livelihood, etc. |
| ☐ Soil pollution | ☐ Land use and utilization of local resources |
| ☒ Waste | ☐ Social institutions such as social infrastructure and local decision-making institutions |
| ☐ Noise and vibration | ☐ Existing social infrastructures and services |
| ☐ Ground subsidence | ☐ Socially vulnerable people (Indigenous people, ethnic minorities) |
| ☐ Offensive odor | ☐ Socially vulnerable people (People in poverty, persons with disabilities, refugees, internally displaced persons, and minorities) |
| ☐ Geographical features | ☐ Misdistribution of benefits and damages |
| ☐ Bottom sediment | ☐ Local conflicts of interest |
| ☐ Biodiversity and ecosystems | ☐ Limitation of accessibility to information, meetings, etc. on a specific person or group |
| ☐ Water usage | ☐ Gender |
| ☐ Accidents | ☐ Children's rights |
| ☒ Climate change | ☐ Cultural heritage |
| | ☐ Infectious diseases such as HIV/AIDS |
| | ☒ Others () |

Outline of related impact: ()

Question 10:

In the case of a project such as a two-step loan or a sector loan, can sub-projects be specified at the present time?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Question 11:

Regarding information disclosure and meetings with stakeholders, if JICA's environmental and social considerations are required, does the proponent agree to information disclosure and meetings with stakeholders through these guidelines?

☒ Yes ☐ No